

ADRIAN MELIAN

TECHNICAL ARTIST · ANIMATOR · MAKER OF THINGS

914.874.3390 · adrianmelian123@gmail.com · adrianmelian.com · Denver, CO (Relocation Ready)

SUMMARY

Lead Technical Artist with 14+ years in AAA game development and 10+ shipped titles. Deep expertise in character rigging, skinning pipelines, and tool development across Sledgehammer Games, Double Fine, Ubisoft, and Meta. Recently focused on ML-driven auto-skinning research using PyTorch to reduce cost and increase pipeline consistency. Equally comfortable managing teams and writing production-grade Python tools.

SKILLS

Disciplines	Rigging, skinning, animation, modeling, pipeline, tools, gameplay programming, graphic design
Software	Maya, Unreal, Unity, ZBrush, Substance Painter, Git, Perforce
Languages	Python, PyQt, PyTorch, C++, C#, Lua

EXPERIENCE

Camouflaj @ Meta | Expert Technical Artist

Remote · Sep 2025 – Jan 2026 · *Unannounced Title (2026)*

- Designed and implemented advanced Maya tools, studio preference systems, and asset stubbing frameworks to streamline setup, prototyping, and daily artist workflows.
- Partnered with Meta Horizon internal teams to troubleshoot complex pipeline challenges.
- Role concluded due to full studio closure as part of company-wide layoffs.

Sledgehammer Games | Lead Technical Artist

Remote · Jan 2021 – Sep 2025 · *Vanguard (2021), MW3 (2023), Unannounced Title (2026)*

- Led the Character Tech Art team and Weapons Tech Art team; trained and managed internal and offshore artists.
- ML research for automated character skin weighting using PyTorch.
- Developed and maintained character, animation, and rigging workflows for AAA productions.
- Created proprietary tools for animation, rigging, game preview, and cloth simulation.
- Skinned high-fidelity characters including celebrity likenesses (Snoop Dogg).
- Built modular rigging solution for weapons pipeline.
- Balanced and optimized character assets for in-engine performance.

Meta | Technical Artist

Menlo Park, CA · Nov 2018 – Dec 2020 · *Meta Horizon Worlds (2021)*

- Created artist-facing tools and animation exporters for VR production.
- Built performance-optimized workflows for VR constraints.
- Developed a Figma-to-ReactVR plugin bridging design and engineering pipelines.

Nomadic VR | Senior Technical Artist

San Rafael, CA · Dec 2017 – Nov 2018 · *Arizona Sunshine: Rampage (2018)*

- Integrated LEAP Motion VR and calibrated OptiTrack & Motive tracking systems.
- Prototyped location-based entertainment (LBE) VR experiences and digital-physical rigs.

NCSOFT | Senior Technical Artist

San Mateo, CA · Jan 2017 – Dec 2017 · *Unannounced Title*

- Built main character rigs and batch rigging tools; developed modular auto-rigging system.
- Authored animation retargeting tools; created 30+ rigs for hero and enemy characters.

Ubisoft | Senior Technical Artist

San Francisco, CA · Aug 2016 – Dec 2016 · *South Park: The Fractured But Whole (2017)*

- Rigged 2D/3D hybrid characters and authored pipeline and 2D flipbook animation tools.

ToyTalk Inc. (now Pullstring) | Senior Technical Artist

San Francisco, CA · Oct 2015 – Jul 2016 · *Unannounced Title*

- Rigged all characters across multiple simultaneous projects.
- Built pose/animation library, Trax editor pipeline, lip-sync tools, and Maya–Unity exporters.
- Authored planetary shaders for procedural galaxy rendering.

Perfect World Entertainment | Technical Artist

Redwood City, CA · Mar 2015 – Oct 2015 · *Unannounced mobile titles*

- Rigged and animated characters, props, and buildings for mobile games.
- Built Maya-to-Unity export tools.

Double Fine Productions | Technical Artist

San Francisco, CA · Jan 2012 – Nov 2014 · *Costume Quest 2, Broken Age, Massive Chalice, Spacebase DF-9, My Alien Buddy, Kinect Party*

- Costume Quest 2: Rigged and skinned 26 of 28 characters; animated gameplay and cutscenes.
- Broken Age: Modeled, rigged, and skinned 40+ characters; built flipbook animation system.
- Massive Chalice: Created map-editing and randomization tools driven by CSV input.
- My Alien Buddy: Concepted and prototyped gameplay, created all characters, wrote Lua scripts.
- Worked on multiple Amnesia Fortnight prototypes (Little Pink Best Buds, Dear Leader, Black Lake, White Birch).

Concept Art House | Technical Artist & Project Manager

San Francisco, CA · Feb 2011 – Sep 2011 · *Various social/browser games (Zoo World 2, Legacy of a Thousand Suns, Vegas City)*

- Created MEL-based auto-rigging tools for bipeds and quadrupeds.
- Managed outsourcing teams, tracked production, and maintained quality standards.
- Authored style guides, tutorials, and assignments for external partners.

EDUCATION

Art Institute of California – San Francisco | B.S. in Media Arts & Animation

San Francisco, CA · Sep 2006 – Dec 2010

- Best Portfolio Award 2010

SUNY Sullivan | A.S. in Graphic Design

New York · Aug 2004 – Aug 2006